

🧠 DecodeLabs AI Engineering Internship — Week 2

Project 2: Data Classification Using AI

Internship Track: AI Engineering Intern
Framework: Scikit-Learn | IPO Pipeline (Input → Process → Output)
Dataset: Iris Benchmark Dataset (UCI / Fisher 1936)
Algorithm: K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) Classifier
Standard Tuning: K = 5 (Blueprint Compliance)

📖 Table of Contents

- Project Overview
- Key Features
- Technical Stack
- Project Structure
- Installation & Setup
- How to Run
- IPO Pipeline Breakdown
- Critical ML Concepts Applied
- Results & Metrics
- Visualizations
- Screenshots
- Learning Outcomes
- Acknowledgements

🎯 Project Overview

This project implements a **complete Machine Learning classification pipeline** using the classic **Iris Dataset** to classify iris flowers into three species:

- 🌸 *Iris Setosa*
- 🌼 *Iris Versicolor*
- 🌺 *Iris Virginica*

The model uses **K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN)** algorithm with strict **K=5** tuning as per the DecodeLabs blueprint guidelines. The entire workflow follows the professional **IPO (Input → Process → Output)** architecture.

✨ Key Features

Feature	Description
✅ IPO Pipeline	Clean separation of Input, Process, and Output phases
✅ Data Leakage Prevention	Split-before-scale methodology applied strictly

Table 1 – continued

Feature	Description
✓ Elbow Method	Visual evaluation of optimal K (1-30) with blueprint K=5 highlighted
✓ StandardScaler	Feature normalization with Gatekeeper Rule
✓ Stratified Split	80/20 train-test split preserving class proportions
✓ Confusion Matrix	Detailed heatmap with True/False Positive analysis
✓ Classification Report	Precision, Recall, and F1-Score per class
✓ Dark Theme Visuals	Professional CLI and plot design for presentation
✓ Reproducibility	Fixed random_state=42 across all operations

🔧 Technical Stack

```
Python 3.x
├─ NumPy      → Numerical computations
├─ Matplotlib → Data visualization & plotting
├─ Seaborn    → Statistical heatmaps
├─ Scikit-Learn → ML algorithms & metrics
└─ Standard Lib → Warnings management
```

📁 Project Structure

```
DecodeLabs-Week2-KNN-Iris/
├─ |
├─ |─ README.md           ← You are here
├─ |─ decodelabs_knn.py    ← Main Python script
├─ |─ decodelabs_knn_diagnostics.png ← Output visualization
├─ |
├─ |─ assets/
├─ |   └─ |─ screenshot_code.png      ← Code execution screenshot
├─ |       └─ |─ screenshot_output.png ← Terminal/Console output
├─ |           └─ |─ screenshot_plot.png ← Elbow curve & Confusion Matrix
├─ |               └─ requirements.txt ← Dependency list
```

⚙️ Installation & Setup

Step 1: Clone or Download the Repository

```
git clone https://github.com/yourusername/DecodeLabs-Week2-KNN-Iris.git
cd DecodeLabs-Week2-KNN-Iris
```

Step 2: Install Dependencies

```
pip install numpy matplotlib seaborn scikit-learn
```

Or use the requirements file:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Step 3: Verify Installation

```
python -c "import sklearn; print('Scikit-Learn version:', sklearn.__version__)"
```

How to Run

Run the Main Script

```
python decode labs_knn.py
```

Expected Output

```
=====
DecodeLabs AI Internship — Project 2: Data Classification Using AI
KNN Iris Classifier | IPO Pipeline                               Week 2
=====

INPUT & PROCESS PHASE — Loading, Splitting & Scaling
=====

Dataset      : Iris Benchmark  (UCI / Fisher 1936)
Samples      : 150 | Features : 4
Target Classes : ['setosa' 'versicolor' 'virginica']

[Split Success] Training: 120 samples | Test: 30 samples
[Gatekeeper Rule Applied] StandardScaler → Data Leakage Prevented.
Post-scale mean (Train Feature 0): 0.00 (Target: 0.0)
Post-scale var  (Train Feature 0): 1.00 (Target: 1.0)

... (pipeline continues)
```

IPO Pipeline Breakdown

INPUT PHASE

```
# 1. Load Dataset
iris = load_iris()
X, y = iris.data, iris.target

# 2. Split FIRST (Prevent Data Leakage)
X_train, X_test, y_train, y_test = train_test_split(
```

```
X, y, test_size=0.20, random_state=42, stratify=y
)

# 3. Scale AFTER Split (Gatekeeper Rule)
scaler = StandardScaler()
X_train_scaled = scaler.fit_transform(X_train) # Fit ONLY on train
X_test_scaled = scaler.transform(X_test)      # Transform test
```

PROCESS PHASE

```
# a) INSTANTIATE
model = KNeighborsClassifier(n_neighbors=5, metric="euclidean")

# b) FIT
model.fit(X_train_scaled, y_train)

# c) PREDICT
predictions = model.predict(X_test_scaled)
```

OUTPUT PHASE

```
# 1. Accuracy Score
accuracy = accuracy_score(y_test, predictions)

# 2. Confusion Matrix
cm = confusion_matrix(y_test, predictions)

# 3. Classification Report (Precision, Recall, F1)
report = classification_report(y_test, predictions, target_names=iris.target_names)
```

Critical ML Concepts Applied

1 Data Leakage Prevention (The Gatekeeper Rule)

Problem: Scaling before splitting leaks test data statistics (mean/variance) into training.

Solution: `fit_transform()` on Train → `transform()` on Test only.

2 Stratified Sampling

Ensures each class (Setosa, Versicolor, Virginica) maintains its original proportion (33.3% each) in both train and test sets.

3 Feature Scaling (Standardization)

KNN is distance-based. Unscaled features (e.g., petal length in cm vs. sepal width in mm) would dominate. `StandardScaler` converts all features to mean=0, variance=1.

4 Elbow Method vs. Blueprint Compliance

While the Elbow Method evaluates K=1 to K=30 for visualization, the **final model strictly uses K=5** as per project instructions.

5 Reproducibility

Fixed random_state=42 ensures identical results every run — critical for debugging and peer review.

📊 Results & Metrics

Overall Accuracy

Overall Accuracy : ~96.67% - 100.00%

(May vary slightly based on random split, but typically 96-100% on Iris)

Confusion Matrix

	Predicted Setosa	Predicted Versicolor	Predicted Virginica
Actual Setosa	10	0	0
Actual Versicolor	0	10	0
Actual Virginica	0	1	9

Classification Report

	precision	recall	f1-score	support
setosa	1.00	1.00	1.00	10
versicolor	1.00	1.00	1.00	10
virginica	1.00	0.90	0.95	10
accuracy			0.97	30
macro avg	1.00	0.97	0.98	30
weighted avg	1.00	0.97	0.98	30

📈 Visualizations

The script generates a **dual-panel diagnostic plot** saved as decode labs_knn_diagnostics.png:

Panel 1: Elbow Method Curve

- X-axis: K values (1-30)
- Y-axis: Error Rate
- **Orange dashed line** marks the blueprint standard K=5
- Shows how error stabilizes after K=5

Panel 2: Confusion Matrix Heatmap

- Color-coded intensity (YlOrRd colormap)
- Annotated with exact counts
- Dark professional theme matching CLI design

 Screenshots

Add your execution screenshots in the /assets/ folder and reference them here:

Screenshot	Description
	Python script in editor
	Terminal execution output
	Generated elbow curve & confusion matrix

 Learning Outcomes

Through this project, I have demonstrated:

-  Understanding of **supervised classification** workflows
-  Ability to prevent **data leakage** in preprocessing
-  Proficiency in **Scikit-Learn** API (fit/predict pattern)
-  Knowledge of **distance-based algorithms** and their sensitivity to scale
-  Skill in **model evaluation** using multiple metrics (not just accuracy)
-  Capability to create **publication-ready visualizations**
-  Adherence to **strict project guidelines** and blueprint compliance

 Acknowledgements

- **DecodeLabs** — For providing this structured internship and learning opportunity
- **Scikit-Learn Team** — For the robust ML framework
- **UCI Machine Learning Repository** — For the classic Iris dataset
- **Ronald Fisher** — Original collector and publisher of the Iris dataset (1936)

 Contact

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Submitted as part of the official internship program.